Daily Content Intel

July 1, 2026

Topic A — Reel

TELEPROMPTER COPY (paste into Instagram)

Okay, so a new meta-analysis just pooled the research on resisted sprint training, and resisted just means you're towing a sled or wearing a weighted vest while you sprint. Here's what they found. When athletes trained against resistance, their straight-line speed went up, their vertical jump went up, and their change of direction improved the most of all. Change of direction is the currency of football and lacrosse. The game is acceleration, a cut, re-acceleration, over and over.

The mechanism is pretty simple. When you push against a load, your body has to put more force into the ground, and you spend more time in that low, driving, acceleration posture. That's the exact position that wins the first 10 yards. So the sled grooves the position and builds the force at the same time.

Here's what your athlete does Monday. Load the sled so they run about 10 to 20 percent slower than their normal sprint. That's the sweet spot, and adolescents respond really well to it. Keep the sprints short, think 10 to 20 yards, full recovery between reps, 2 to 3 days a week. If the goal is that first burst and the cut, lean on the sled. If you want the whole explosive package, pair it with some jumps.

I use this with my football and lacrosse guys because it carries straight to the field. Faster first step, sharper cut, back in the play.

Be Good. Help Someone. Learn Lots.

Hook: Want your athlete a step faster off the line? Load a sled.

Spoken script (word for word):

Okay, so a new meta-analysis just pooled the research on resisted sprint training, and resisted just means you're towing a sled or wearing a weighted vest while you sprint. Here's what they found. When athletes trained against resistance, their straight-line speed went up, their vertical jump went up, and their change of direction improved the most of all. Change of direction is the currency of football and lacrosse. The game is acceleration, a cut, re-acceleration, over and over.

The mechanism is pretty simple. When you push against a load, your body has to put more force into the ground, and you spend more time in that low, driving, acceleration posture. That's the exact position that wins the first 10 yards. So the sled grooves the position and builds the force at the same time.

Here's what your athlete does Monday. Load the sled so they run about 10 to 20 percent slower than their normal sprint. That's the sweet spot, and adolescents respond really well to it. Keep the sprints short, think 10 to 20 yards, full recovery between reps, 2 to 3 days a week. If the goal is that first burst and the cut, lean on the sled. If you want the whole explosive package, pair it with some jumps.

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On-screen text seeds:

- 0:00 SLED = SPEED
- 0:08 New 2025 meta-analysis: resisted sprint training
- 0:22 ■ Sprint speed ■ Vertical jump ■■ Change of direction
- 0:35 More force into the ground = better acceleration posture
- 0:52 Load so they run 10-20% slower than free sprint
- 1:05 Short sprints (10-20 yds) • full rest • 2-3x/week

- 1:18 Faster first step. Sharper cut.

Caption (copy-paste ready):

Resisted sprint training is one of the highest-carryover tools I have for field-sport athletes.

A new meta-analysis (Frontiers in Physiology, 2025) pooled the research on towing a sled or wearing a weighted vest while you sprint. Straight-line speed went up, vertical jump went up, and change of direction improved the most. Change of direction is the currency of football and lacrosse.

How to run it: load the sled so your athlete moves about 10-20% slower than their free sprint, keep the sprints short (10-20 yards), full recovery between reps, 2-3 days a week. Want the whole explosive package? Pair it with jumps.

Faster first step, sharper cut, back in the play.

Dr. Lars Stevenson, PT, DPT It's time to cross your threshold.

Book: threshold.clientsecure.me

#footballtraining #lacrosse #speedtraining #strengthandconditioning #youthathlete #sportsperformance #athleticdevelopment #returntosport #sprinttraining #physicaltherapy

Personalize this

- Which of your NoVA football and club-lacrosse athletes would you put behind a sled first, and are you chasing first-step burst or the change-of-direction cut for each?
- You program HS football in-season and offseason. Where does resisted sprinting fit in a week that already has a heavy field-sprint load, and how do you fold it into CROSS without piling on?
- Have you had a return-to-sport athlete where sled work rebuilt acceleration confidence after a knee or hamstring injury? That story would make this land harder than the numbers.

Screenshots:

- title | https://pmc.ncbi.nlm.nih.gov/articles/PMC12689304/ | "Effects of resisted sprint training on sprint, jump, and change-of-direction performance in athletes: a systematic review and meta-analysis"
- physiology | https://pmc.ncbi.nlm.nih.gov/articles/PMC12689304/ | "RST significantly improved linear sprint performance (SMD = 0.65, p < 0.001)"
- actionable | https://pmc.ncbi.nlm.nih.gov/articles/PMC12689304/ | "when loads are set so athletes run about 10%–20% slower than their normal unresisted speed, adolescents tend to respond particularly well"

Sources:

- https://pmc.ncbi.nlm.nih.gov/articles/PMC12689304/

Topic B — Reel

TELEPROMPTER COPY (paste into Instagram)

Okay, hot take. The agility ladder is probably the most overrated drill in youth sports. Let me explain.

Real agility only shows up when your athlete has to react. Reading a defender, deciding where to go, and cutting in response to something actually happening in front of them. That reaction is the whole skill. A ladder pattern has none of it. Your athlete knows every step before their foot even lands, so it's basically choreography, and the game never lets them rehearse.

Now, I'm not trashing ladders completely. They're fine for a warm-up, for coordination, for teaching a young kid to organize their feet. But if you think 20 minutes of fancy footwork makes your kid shifty on the field, the research just doesn't support that. Change of direction speed and true game agility are kind of two separate skills, and the ladder only trains the easy one.

So here's what I do instead. I give the drill a live stimulus. One on one evasion. A partner who points left or right at the last second. A coach who calls the cut live. Anything that forces the athlete to see it, decide, and go, because that's exactly what happens on Saturday.

Make them react. That's where agility actually lives.

Be Good. Help Someone. Learn Lots.

Hook: The agility ladder might be the most overrated drill in youth sports.

Spoken script (word for word):

Okay, hot take. The agility ladder is probably the most overrated drill in youth sports. Let me explain.

Real agility only shows up when your athlete has to react. Reading a defender, deciding where to go, and cutting in response to something actually happening in front of them. That reaction is the whole skill. A ladder pattern has none of it. Your athlete knows every step before their foot even lands, so it's basically choreography, and the game never lets them rehearse.

Now, I'm not trashing ladders completely. They're fine for a warm-up, for coordination, for teaching a young kid to organize their feet. But if you think 20 minutes of fancy footwork makes your kid shifty on the field, the research just doesn't support that. Change of direction speed and true game agility are kind of two separate skills, and the ladder only trains the easy one.

So here's what I do instead. I give the drill a live stimulus. One on one evasion. A partner who points left or right at the last second. A coach who calls the cut live. Anything that forces the athlete to see it, decide, and go, because that's exactly what happens on Saturday.

Make them react. That's where agility actually lives.

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On-screen text seeds:

- 0:00 The agility ladder is overrated
- 0:10 Real agility = REACTION
- 0:24 A ladder pattern is memorized (zero reaction)
- 0:40 Ladders are fine for warm-up + coordination
- 0:52 Change of direction speed ≠ game agility
- 1:05 Add a stimulus: 1v1 • partner cue • coach calls the cut
- 1:18 See it. Decide. Go.

Caption (copy-paste ready):

Hot take: the agility ladder is probably the most overrated drill in youth sports.

Real agility is reactive. It's reading a defender and cutting in response to something happening in front of you. A ladder pattern is memorized, so it never trains the reaction, and the reaction is the whole skill.

Ladders aren't worthless. They're fine for warm-ups, coordination, and teaching a young athlete to organize their feet. But change of direction speed and true game agility are two different skills, and the ladder only touches the easy one.

Train the harder one: give the drill a live stimulus. 1v1 evasion, a partner pointing left or right at the last second, a coach calling the cut. See it, decide, go.

Dr. Lars Stevenson, PT, DPT It's time to cross your threshold.

Book: threshold.clientsecure.me

#agilitytraining #footballtraining #lacrosse #youthsports #speedandagility #athleticdevelopment #strengthandconditioning #sportsperformance #coaching #physicaltherapy

Personalize this

- What's the drill you see HS football and lacrosse coaches lean on hardest that you think has the worst carryover to the game, and what do you swap it for?

- Give one reactive agility drill you actually run at Threshold (partner cue, coach call, 1v1 evasion) and an athlete it visibly changed on the field.
- How does the CROSS framework help you separate closed change-of-direction speed from open, reactive agility when you build an athlete's plan?

Screenshots:

- title | https://www.scienceforsport.com/five-ways-to-develop-elite-agility-in-invasion-sports/ | "Five Ways to Develop Elite Agility in Invasion Sports"
- physiology | https://www.scienceforsport.com/five-ways-to-develop-elite-agility-in-invasion-sports/ | "Agility is reactive in nature. Hence why the term 'reactive' agility is redundant. If there is no reaction, it's not agility."
- actionable | https://www.scienceforsport.com/five-ways-to-develop-elite-agility-in-invasion-sports/ | "Provide a sport-specific context for your agility drills such as 1v1 evasion drills, not pre-planned cone and

ladder drills."

Sources:

- https://www.scienceforsport.com/five-ways-to-develop-elite-agility-in-invasion-sports/

Reference

Runner-up topics

- 11+ / neuromuscular warm-up ACL prevention translated to community-level implementation (National ACL Injury Coalition) — action-framed, once it clears the 90-day overlap with recent Nordic/plyo/lower-limb picks.
- Pre-sleep protein and overnight recovery in athletes — reframe away from the female-athlete-only source and toward "how the last meal before bed helps you adapt."
- Repeated-sprint ability + strength training for team-sport conditioning — the smarter alternative to long-slow "gasser" conditioning.

Sources scanned today

- Newsletter digest (newsletter_digest_2026-07-01.pdf): single source, a Dr. Mercola promo email (gut microbiome teaser, bone/joint + NAC ads). No clinical finding to work with. Skipped.

- PubMed / Frontiers in Physiology: resisted sprint training meta-analysis (2025) — strong athlete-actionable finding. USED (Draft A).
- Web scan on ACL/hamstring prevention (National ACL Coalition, 11+): confirmed neuromuscular warm-up value but overlaps recent registry topics (Nordic, plyo, lower-limb strength). Held as runner-up.
- Web scan on protein/sleep/energy availability for adolescent athletes: pre-sleep protein + sleep quality — decent but nuanced/null result, and leans female-athlete demographic in the cleanest source. Skipped for today.
- Web scan on agility ladders vs reactive game agility (Science for Sport, de Lacey): clean coaching-science hot take, fresh URL. USED (Draft B).
- Static-stretch-before-performance angle: recent meta-analyses say it does NOT meaningfully hurt sprint/jump (only isolated strength), and the stretch-induced force deficit paper is already in the 90-day

registry. Rejected.